BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #18 · AGING AND DECLINE

"I've lost my purpose."

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Where it often comes from

When career, children at home, or health-related roles change, the schedule and the sense of mission change too. Without clear tasks, days feel empty and the question "What am I for?" arises.

What Scripture teaches

"The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me" (Psalm 138:8). "He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus." Jesus said, "Love the Lord your God… and love your neighbor as yourself." Those two purposes do not retire. Paul says we are God's workmanship "created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life." Purpose is not only a job title. It is loving God and others in whatever season.

> *"The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever—do not abandon the works of Your hands"* (Psalm 138:8).

Also see

> "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus" (Philippians 1:6).

> "For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life" (Ephesians 2:10).

> "Love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind and with all your strength.' The second is this: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.' No other commandment is greater than these" (Mark 12:30–31).

> "In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain" (Psalm 92:14).

Common self-statements

- I have no reason to get up.
- What am I for now?
- No one needs me.
- My work is done.
- I am just waiting.
- I have nothing to live for.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing purpose is either a career or nothing.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always feel empty.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling aimless and concluding that I have no purpose.
- Labeling: Calling myself purposeless.

Challenging questions

- What roles have I lost, and what have I gained?

- What are the two great commands, and how can I live them today?
- Who is near me who could use a kind word, a meal, or a prayer?
- What skills or interests have I set aside?
- What did I love as a child or young adult?
- What is one thing to do this week that matters to someone?

Truth summary

> My purpose is bigger than a job or role. God's purposes for me continue, and I can love Him and my neighbor in this season. He will complete what He began in me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Will of God
- Elderly
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Guidance
- Hopeless

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I've lost my purpose"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I've lost my purpose." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What roles have I lost, and what have I gained?
- ☐ What are the two great commands, and how can I live them today?
- ☐ Who is near me who could use a kind word, a meal, or a prayer?
- ☐ What skills or interests have I set aside?
- ☐ What did I love as a child or young adult?
- ☐ What is one thing to do this week that matters to someone?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Lord will fulfill His purpose for me.
- ☐ He will complete His work in me.
- ☐ I was made for good works.
- ☐ I can love God and neighbor.
- ☐ Each day has purpose.
- ☐ God is not finished with me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 138:8**
  "The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever— do not abandon the works of Your hands."
- ☐ **Philippians 1:6**
  "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus."
- ☐ **Ephesians 2:10**
  "For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Purpose today: Each week, note one act of love for God or neighbor.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 138:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord will fulfill His purpose for me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Will of God" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List your roles. Write the old and new ones.
- [ ] Serve one person. Meet a need near you.
- [ ] Revisit a passion. Pick up an old interest.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 138:8. Ask God to show your purpose.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I've lost my purpose": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Purpose today
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I've lost my purpose.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You will fulfill Your purpose for me. Show me how to love You and my neighbor in this season, and use me today. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.